

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

HAND AND POWER TOOLS

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Review cutting, crushing, entanglement, electric-shock, accessory failure and flying-particle hazards during the selection, inspection and use of hand and power tools, and verify equipment, guarding and PPE controls before work begins. Every tool must be used only for its intended purpose. Using a screwdriver as a chisel, a wrench as a hammer or an unsuitable disc on a grinder can lead to loss of control and equipment failure.

KEY HAZARDS

1



MISSING GUARD

2



PROJECTILE

3



ENTANGLEMENT

4



ELECTRICAL

5



SPARKS

6



VIBRATION

7



NOISE

8



WRONG ACCESSORY

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

Tool ≥ wheel speed

Accessory speed compatibility

100%

Guard and handle fitted

0

Damaged cable, body or wheel



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1926 Subpart I requires tools to be maintained in safe condition with guards, correct accessories and controls specific to the power source.

OSHA 1926.300(a) SAFE CONDITION

Maintain all hand and power tools in safe condition and remove defective equipment from service.

OSHA 1926.300(b) GUARDING

Keep manufacturer guards installed, correctly adjusted and secure during operation.

OSHA 1926.302(a) ELECTRIC TOOLS

Verify grounding or double insulation; never carry a tool or pull a plug by its cord.

OSHA 1926.303 ABRASIVE WHEELS

Verify wheel speed, compatibility, damage inspection, guarding and secure workpiece support.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Pre-use inspection | ☐ Tool / accessory speed check |
| ☐ Guard and handle check | ☐ Electrical / RCD check |
| ☐ Operator competency record | ☐ Hot-work control for sparks |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Have the tools and accessories been inspected?
- Are all guards fitted and functional?
- Is the disc or bit compatible with the tool?

GUARDED GRINDING AND WORKPIECE CONTROL



Correct wheel - Guard - Side handle - Clamp - Screen - PPE

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. CHOOSE A SAFER METHOD

Inspect the tool and accessories before use. Use only approved equipment suitable for the task.

2. SELECT THE CORRECT TOOL AND ACCESSORY

Keep guards fitted and functional. Verify disc size and maximum speed compatibility. Isolate power before changing accessories.

3. GUARD AND SECURE

Secure the workpiece and maintain a stable position. Route cables and hoses safely. Use suitable eye, face, hand and hearing protection.

4. INSPECT AND USE WITH DISCIPLINE

Quarantine and report damaged equipment. Do not complete unauthorised repairs or modifications.

CRITICAL WARNING



Do not use damaged, unguarded equipment or tools fitted with unsuitable accessories. Stop work and quarantine the tool.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Tool intact | ☐ Cable and plug intact |
| ☐ Guard fitted | ☐ Accessory suitable |
| ☐ Speed compatibility verified | ☐ Workpiece secured |
| ☐ Cable route safe | ☐ PPE suitable |
| ☐ Area controlled | |

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			